ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** individuals, enterprises and governments	All economic entities face choices
2	**(c)** unlimited and changing	Wants keep growing
3	**(b)** labour-intensive	More workers, less machinery
4	**(a)** both private enterprise and government participation	Combination of the two
5	**(b)** Money-lender	Land, labour, capital and technology
6	**(b)** short-term profit and long-term sustainability	Water use and soil health
7	**(a)** for whom to produce	Target consumer group
8	**(a)** choices must be made	Steel for aircraft or refrigerators
9	**(b)** a referee in a football match	Rule-keeper
10	**(d)** planned economies	Government control of resources

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The arrangement deciding how goods, services and resources are produced, consumed and distributed (1); Types are planned, market and mixed (1).	1+1
12	A place where goods and services are bought and sold (1); An online shopping site is a virtual market (1).	1+1
13	Goods available to all without anyone being excluded (1); Parks and street lights (1).	1+1
14	Wants are unlimited while resources are limited (1); This forces people to choose (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Sugarcane gives high profit but needs much water (1); Millets save water and improve soil (1); Choice is between short-term gain and sustainability (1).	1+1+1
16	Handmade designer clothes need skilled labour (1); Mass-produced garments suit machines (1); Choice depends on product and cost (1).	1+1+1
17	Maintains law and order (1); Ensures safety and provides public goods and infrastructure (1); Acts like a referee ensuring fair play (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Demand and supply decide prices (1); Mostly private ownership (1); Competition improves quality and innovation (1).	1+1+1
18	Guesswork can waste scarce resources (1); Surveys and statements show trends (1); Alternatives and their costs can then be compared (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It lists combinations producible with all resources used (1); More barley means less wheat (1); The wheat given up is the opportunity cost (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	What to produce: sugarcane versus millets (1); How to produce: labour-intensive versus capital-intensive methods (1); For whom to produce: shoes for students, professionals, athletes (1); These arise from scarcity (1); Answers depend on the economic system (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Cost of capital (1); Cost and availability of labour (1); Level of technology (1); Nature of the product (custom or mass-produced) (1); Laws and regulations (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Wants are unlimited, resources limited (1); Individuals divide pocket money or income (1); Firms choose workers or machines (1); Governments choose highways or hospitals (1); Each choice has an opportunity cost (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: They study how choices use limited resources (1); Advise governments on policy and tax (1); Help firms and investors plan (1); Use surveys, government reports and company statements (1); Data avoids wasteful guesswork (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** demand and supply	Market forces
2	**(c)** a place, physical or online, where goods and services are bought and sold	Markets can be virtual too
3	**(a)** 1991	After a serious economic crisis
4	**(b)** A household	Consumers, producers and government interact
5	**(a)** state-led approach close to a planned economy	Licences and public sector dominated
6	**(d)** wants are unlimited but resources are limited	Mismatch of wants and resources
7	**(a)** use more machines	Cost of capital affects technique
8	**(d)** producing more of one good means giving up some of the other	Trade-off
9	**(c)** 10 kg of wheat	Wheat given up = 100 - 90
10	**(d)** the best other thing the money could have bought	Next best alternative forgone

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Value of the best alternative given up (1); Spending an evening on a game means giving up study time (1).	1+1
12	What to produce (1); How to produce and for whom to produce (1).	1+1
13	Government reports such as economic surveys (1); Financial statements of companies (1).	1+1
14	Everyone has only a limited number of hours (1); Using time on one activity means giving up another (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A serious economic difficulty arose (1); Rules were relaxed and private enterprise encouraged (1); Trade and investment were opened to the world (1).	1+1+1
16	Different groups have different needs and incomes (1); School shoes are simple and affordable; sports shoes have special soles (1); Producers study demand so resources are not wasted (1).	1+1+1
17	Cost of capital (1); Cost and availability of labour (1); Level of technology (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Barley rises by 25 kg (1); Wheat falls from 70 to 40 (1); Opportunity cost is 30 kg of wheat (1).	1+1+1
18	A central authority takes decisions (1); Government owns most resources (1); Little competition and incentive to innovate (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Roads, parks and street lights (1); Everyone can use them (1); They support daily life and development (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Define opportunity cost as value of next best alternative given up (1); Table: A (0,100), B (25,90), C (50,70), D (75,40), E (100,0) (1); Each extra 25 kg barley costs 10, 20, 30, 40 kg wheat (1); The cost rises as more barley is grown (1); PPC slopes downward showing the trade-off (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Greek oikonomia means household management (1); Wants unlimited, resources limited, so scarcity (1); Alternatives and opportunity costs must be weighed (1); Households, firms and governments decide with data (1); Aim is to use resources best to raise quality of life (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Public goods are open to all without exclusion (1); Examples: roads, parks, police (1); Private goods are bought by paying (1); Markets may under-provide public goods (1); Government supplies and maintains them (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: State-led approach with licences and permits (1); Public sector dominated banking and heavy industry (1); 1991 crisis led to reform (1); Less regulation, more private enterprise, global trade (1); Mixed economy with market orientation (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** a combination of goods produced using all resources efficiently	Maximum output combinations
2	**(d)** Drinking water - need; designer watch - want	Needs are essentials
3	**(c)** a central planning authority	Government decides
4	**(d)** what, how and for whom to produce	Core economic questions
5	**(a)** 20 kg of wheat	90 - 70 = 20
6	**(a)** skilled labour	Nature of the product
7	**(b)** capital-intensive	More machinery, fewer workers
8	**(a)** household management	oikos = household, nemein = management
9	**(d)** are available to all without exclusion	Non-excludable goods
10	**(b)** USA	Market-oriented economy

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Different combinations of two goods that can be produced with all resources used efficiently (1); Its downward slope shows the trade-off (1).	1+1
12	An annual Ministry of Finance review of the economy (1); Presented in Parliament before the Union Budget (1).	1+1
13	Needs are essentials such as food, water and shelter (1); Wants are things desired for comfort, unlimited and changing (1).	1+1
14	Labour-intensive uses more workers, e.g. handicrafts (1); Capital-intensive uses more machines, e.g. automobiles (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It reviews last year's performance of agriculture, industry and services (1); It discusses future challenges (1); It works as a blueprint for the Budget (1).	1+1+1
16	Resources are limited but have many uses (1); Using them for one purpose means giving up another (1); So households and governments must prioritise (1).	1+1+1
17	Needs are essentials such as food and medicines (1); Wants are non-essentials such as gadgets (1); Wants grow, e.g. cycle to bike to car (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Pure systems rarely work (1); Private firms and markets are combined with regulation (1); Government provides public goods and welfare (1).	1+1+1
18	They separate essentials such as food and medicines (1); Non-essentials such as jewellery and entertainment (1); They also keep some income as savings (1).	1+1+1
	OR: State-led, close to a planned economy (1); Licences and permits controlled production (1); Public sector dominated banking, transport and heavy industry (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Planned: central authority decides, government owns resources (1); Market: demand and supply decide, private ownership (1); Mixed: both private firms and government (1); Examples: Cuba, USA, India (1); Government acts as referee in market and mixed systems (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Sugarcane is profitable but needs much water (1); Millets and pulses save water and improve soil (1); Sugarcane supports the sugar industry (1); Millets support sustainable farming (1); Short-term gain versus long-term sustainability (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Planned: central authority, e.g. Cuba (1); Market: demand and supply, e.g. USA (1); Mixed: both sectors, e.g. India (1); Pure forms are rare (1); Government acts as referee in a market (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: Labour-intensive: many workers, e.g. handicrafts (1); Capital-intensive: machines, e.g. steel (1); Cost of capital and labour matters (1); Technology and nature of product matter (1); Laws also shape the choice (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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